



Organic farming: Council negotiating position on simpler and clearer organic farming rules agreed

Today, the member states at the Special Committee on Agriculture agreed on a negotiating position for updating the EU rules on organic production and labelling. The aim is to make the rules simpler to follow, clearer to interpret, and to support the continued growth of the organic sector across Europe.

The proposed updates focus on selected areas of the existing framework while keeping the EU's high standards for organic products. By doing so, the Council hopes to maintain consumer trust in the EU organic label, reduce administrative burdens for farmers, businesses, and national authorities, and strengthen the competitiveness and resilience of the organic sector.



Organic farming is a strategic asset for Europe's food systems, biodiversity and rural areas. Member states want rules that are simpler, clearer and better fit to the realities on the ground. But we want to do so while preserving the high standards and consumer confidence that underpin the success of the EU organic sector.

Maria Panayiotou, Minister of Agriculture, Rural Development and Environment of the Republic of Cyprus

The Council's position focuses in particular on:

- **simplification and flexibility:** Council wants to simplify rules for small operators, including exemptions from certification and adjustments to turnover thresholds. Small online retailers of pre-packed organic products will be exempt from certification under certain conditions. This aims to reduce administrative burdens and encourage participation in organic farming.
- **imported organic products and labeling:** The Council's position clarifies that products imported from countries with organic production systems recognised as equivalent to the EU's cannot use the EU organic logo but can use the organic logo of their country of origin. The Council at the same time supports allowing the EU organic logo to be used on imported products if they meet additional production and control requirements beyond the equivalence standards, ensuring they approach the rigor of EU organic standards. This aims to facilitate trade and maintain consumer trust.
- **removing Commission's proposal to allow the EU organic label on products containing up to 5% ingredients from third countries that do not meet additional criteria.**
- **temporary use of non-organic inputs:** Temporary flexibility is introduced for non-organic protein feed for poultry and pigs, and for aquaculture juveniles, with a plan to phase out these derogations gradually.

The Council's position also allows products already labeled under the old system to continue being sold until stocks are exhausted. This will avoid market disruption. Transitional measures ensure continuity and legal certainty for imported organic products and trade as the new rules are implemented.

Next steps

Negotiations between the Council presidency and the European Parliament are expected to start as soon as possible. The EU aims to find an agreement before the end of the year to ensure smooth transition of the recognition of third countries whose organic production and control systems have been recognised as equivalent to those of the Union. Current agreement expires on 31 December 2026.

Background

The EU organic production framework is laid down in regulation (EU) 2018/848, which has applied since January 2022. The framework establishes rules for organic production, certification and labelling across the EU.

The Commission presented its proposal for a targeted revision of the organic legislation as part of its roadmap “Organic rulebook fit for the future”.

Organic farming continues to play an important role in the EU's transition towards more sustainable food systems. According to the Commission, there are more than 381 000 organic farmers in the EU, representing an increase of 30% since 2018.

- [Mandate for negotiations with the European Parliament](#)
- [Commission proposal](#)
- [EU Law Tracker](#)

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